

DH2027 Short Paper — Outline

Working title: *Three Registers of Thai Regional Cooking: What the State, the Market, and the Kitchen Each Record*

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Deadline: 20 November 2026, 23:59 AoE

Submission requirements (DH2027 CFP)

Item	Requirement
Format	Short paper — for work in progress, experiments and exploratory research; ~10-minute presentation
Length	1,000–1,250 words , including captions; excluding table contents and references
Language	English
Review	Not anonymous — name, school and GitHub link may appear
AI disclosure	Required; does not count toward the word limit
Figures / tables	Allowed; may be placed in an appendix
Theme	<i>Creativity</i> — as object of study, research practice, and feature of digital environments
Review criteria	Current knowledge and references · advancement beyond existing practice · methodological clarity · diversity of perspectives · writing clarity

Core claim (one sentence)

The same cuisine documented by three actors with three different motives — the state, the commercial web, and home cooks — produces three measurably different records, and the gaps between them are a finding about how cultural datasets are made.

Section plan — target 1,200 words

1. Opening: the kitchen · ~150 words

- First sentence starts with cooking, not method. Method enters no earlier than sentence three.
- **[Origin story — fill in after cooking the dish on or before 26 Oct. Use what actually happened, including what contradicted the remembered version. Do not draft this from memory.]**
- Turn: the family version of the dish is not the version the government lists, nor the version a recipe site publishes. Which one is "Thai regional food"?

2. Background and gap · ~200 words

- Computational gastronomy treats recipes as bags of ingredients (e.g. Ahn et al. 2011, flavour networks).
- Critical dataset studies show that corpora carry the choices of whoever assembled them (e.g. Gebru et al. 2021, *Datasheets for Datasets*).

- Heritage studies describe state curation as an "authorised" discourse (Smith 2006, *Uses of Heritage*).
- **Gap 1:** no study compares state-curated, commercial and domestic records of the same cuisine for the same provinces.
- **Gap 2:** standard distinctiveness measures (log-odds, Monroe et al. 2008; Zeta, Burrows 2007) measure presence only — a region's refusals are invisible to them.
- *Verify every citation and add 2–3 Thai food-studies sources before submission.*

3. Data: three registers · ~300 words

Include Table 1 (counts in table cells do not count toward the word limit).

Register	Source	Size (update before submission)	Selection pressure
Official	Department of Cultural Promotion local-food forms, food.culture.go.th , programme year 2568	231 PDFs, 3 dishes × 77 provinces; [201] loaded, [73] provinces	Cultural policy, provincial representation
Commercial	cooking.kapook.com	[1,360] recipes; [n] province-labelled	Web publishing, ingredient availability, readership
Domestic	Interviews, Nakhon Ratchasima and Buri Ram	Target 12; [n] completed by submission	Season, cost, habit, what grows nearby

- Each register is a biased sample; none is the ground truth — the comparison is the instrument.
- Ethics: personal data stripped at parse time under Thailand's PDPA, with a database-wide test; robots.txt / ToS audits dated; consent forms in Thai; parent present at every interview; ingredient lists only, no recipe prose redistributed.
- One sentence on the two Thai PDF extraction traps (sara am, checkbox glyphs) — signals methodological care; details go to the JCSSE paper.

4. Method · ~250 words

- Ingredient normalisation to a controlled Thai vocabulary ([~150] entries at submission; target ~400), each mapping decision logged.
- Province × ingredient vectors per register; pairwise cosine distance (official↔commercial now; three-way for the two fieldwork provinces later).
- Sample sizes reported beside every distance — registers are unequal (3 vs. [n] vs. ~6).
- Planned: presence/absence decomposition of distinctiveness, validated against interview question 9, "*What do people in other provinces put in this that we would never put in?*" (อะไรที่คนจังหวัดอื่นใส่ในงานนี้ แต่บ้านเราไม่มีวันใส่?)
- Planned: cooking eight dishes from the *cleaned* dataset to measure what normalisation destroys.

5. Preliminary results · ~200 words

Do not write until the 1-8 Nov analysis is run. No numbers before then.

- Distribution of official↔commercial distance across provinces: [median, range].
- Provinces where the registers agree most and least: [names].
- Figure 1 (appendix): province × ingredient heatmap, seriated by clustering, faceted by register.
- Fieldwork status: [n] interviews completed; one concrete early observation if one exists.
- Report a null or weak result plainly if that is what the data shows.

6. Creativity: cooking as a research method · ~100 words

- Ties to the DH2027 theme.
- Recipes are creative practice; pipelines flatten them. Cooking from the normalised data is a way of testing a dataset that only someone who cooks can perform.
- Domestic cooks' substitutions and refusals are creative acts that no official or commercial record captures.

7. Limitations and next steps · ~100 words

- 3 official dishes per province; one commercial source; fieldwork in two neighbouring Isaan provinces only.
- Endangerment level is self-reported by submitters.
- Next: complete fieldwork (Dec 2026), release OpenFlavorTH on HuggingFace (Jan 2027), full paper by March 2027. Results will be presented in Galway.

AI disclosure (not counted)

I used Claude Code to build the data pipeline and scrapers and to debug Thai text extraction. Every analytical decision — vocabulary granularity, labelling rules, thresholds and the distinctiveness definition — is mine and is documented with its reasoning in docs/decisions.md. The text of this proposal is my own.

Only keep the last sentence if it is true at submission.

References (not counted)

Ahn et al. 2011 · Burrows 2007 · Gebru et al. 2021 · Monroe, Colaresi & Quinn 2008 · Smith 2006 · 2-3 Thai food-studies sources · DCP source citation · OpenFlavorTH GitHub repository.

Writing schedule

Date	Task
by 26 Oct	Origin dish cooked → write Section 1
by 1 Nov	Sections 2-4 drafted (no results needed)
1-8 Nov	Run preliminary RQ1 and heatmap
9-12 Nov	Section 5; full first draft; word count check
~10 Nov	Send draft to mentor for a 30-minute review
13-18 Nov	Revise; verify every citation; final numbers into Table 1
19 Nov	Final read aloud; create ConfTool account
20 Nov	Submit

Reviewer checklist

- Does the opening start in a kitchen?
- Is every number traceable to a commit or query?
- Are sample sizes stated beside every comparison?
- Is the creativity theme connected explicitly, not decoratively?
- Is the gap stated as a disagreement with existing practice?

- Word count between 1,000 and 1,250 (captions included)?